Study Strategies

Try a few on your next test and keep the ones that work for you.

01 The study cycle

One method that combines several strategies

1 — Look it over
Read your notes, do a study guide, or look over homework.

→

2 — Self-quiz
Make a mock test like the real one. Take it notes closed.

→

3 — Sort it
Check answers. Mark each **got it, shaky, or didn't know.**

→

4 — Study the gaps
Mostly what you missed, review of the rest.

→

5 — Quiz again
Notes closed. Misses go first next session.

Repeat it on a different day. Each round, your "didn't know" list should get shorter.

02 More ways to study

Mix and match what works for you

Self-quiz

Pull answers from memory with your notes closed. Before a test, quiz in its format and time limit.

TRY IT
Flashcards, a blank page, or a timed review sheet.

Mix it up

Mix topics or question types instead of doing one kind in a row. You practice choosing what to do.

TRY IT
Shuffle flashcards from three chapters into one stack.

Explain it simply

Explain it in plain words, like teaching a younger student. Where you stall is what to study.

TRY IT
Teach it to a parent, a friend, or an empty chair.

Ask why and how

For each fact, ask why it's true or how it connects to something you already know.

TRY IT
Why did it happen, and what changed after?

Learn from examples

Study a strong example, like a solved problem or a model essay, then try one yourself.

TRY IT
Study a sample paragraph, then write one.

SQ3R

Survey the chapter, turn headings into **Q**uestions, **R**ead, **R**ecite without looking, **R**eview.

TRY IT
"Causes of the War" becomes "What caused it?"

Study Strategies

KNOW WHAT YOU KNOW

Feeling vs. knowing. Rereading makes notes feel familiar, and familiar feels like learned. The real check is notes closed.

Traffic light topics. 🟢🟡🔴 After a self-quiz, mark each topic green, yellow, or red. Spend most of your time on red and yellow.

03 Put it on the calendar

Spreading it out works with any method

MON	TUE	THU	FRI
First session. Learn it and quiz yourself.	Quiz again and fix what you missed.	One last quiz on everything.	Test day

04 Sit down and do it

Make each session count

Set a session goal

Write one sentence on what you'll be able to do by the end. Check it off when you're done.

TRY IT
"By 8:00 I can explain the three causes of the war."

Pomodoro

Work 25 minutes, break 5. After four rounds, take a longer break. A timer makes it easier to start.

TRY IT
Timer on, one task, then a real break.

One thing at a time

Your phone near you can lead to distraction. Out of sight beats face down. Turn on Do not Disturb.

TRY IT
Do Not Disturb on for the whole session.

Protect your sleep

Sleep locks in what you studied. Staying up to cram trades away what you just learned.

TRY IT
Pick a study stop time. Same bedtime all week.

Take it one step further

Keep doing these, then add the next step

Highlighting
→ **Turn your highlights into questions.**

Copying notes
→ **Summarize them in your own words.**

Doing homework
→ **Star where you got stuck and redo it later.**

Reading the textbook
→ **Close it after each section, say the main idea.**